

Acquisition Proposal

Title Information

Title	The Midnight Garden
Author	Elena Marchetti
Genre	Literary Fiction
Proposed Advance	\$70,000
First Print Run	25,000
Marketing Budget	\$50,000

Book Description

When three generations of a family unraveling a shared secret, the consequences ripple outward in ways no one could have predicted. Set in a foreign city, this spare work examines the spaces between intention and impact, between the stories we tell ourselves and the truths we cannot escape. Questions of consciousness, displacement, silence, and solitude drive the narrative forward with compelling urgency. Rather than offering simple resolutions, the story sits with ambiguity, acknowledging that these fundamental human concerns resist tidy conclusions. The result is a work that rewards reflection and rereading. The characters are rendered with remarkable specificity, their voices distinct and their motivations layered. As the story of three generations of a family unraveling a shared secret...

Comparable Titles (Selected by Content Similarity)

5 titles selected from a pool of 30 candidates via semantic similarity.

#	Title	Author	Sim.	Imprint	Units	Revenue	NYT
1	Himself and Black	Stephanie Odone	80%	Crown	26,481	\$175,198	3
2	A Specific in New Di	Heather Brooks	78%	Harper Perenni	34,625	\$233,788	2
3	The Pass of Debate	Gabrielle Brown	77%	Crown	718,119	\$8,249,751	28
4	Michael's Region	Bryan Washington	75%	Little, Brown	585,178	\$6,458,024	37
5	A Force in North Bra	Patty Bailey DDS	74%	Viking	4,548	\$53,503	0

Comp Analysis Summary

Median units sold	34,625
Average units sold	273,790
Range	4,548 - 718,119
Median net revenue	\$233,788
Avg similarity score	76.8%

Financial Forecast (5-Year P&L)

Year	Units	Gross Rev	Net Rev	COGS	Royalties	Marketing	Contribution
Year 1	22,814	\$494,938	\$279,640	\$35,931	\$57,326	\$30,000	\$156,383
Year 2	8,121	\$176,181	\$99,542	\$12,789	\$20,406	\$12,500	\$53,847
Year 3	3,894	\$84,478	\$47,730	\$6,132	\$9,785	\$2,500	\$29,314
Year 4	1,947	\$42,239	\$23,865	\$3,066	\$4,892	\$2,500	\$13,407
Year 5	778	\$16,878	\$9,536	\$1,225	\$1,955	\$2,500	\$3,856
TOTAL	37,554	\$814,715	\$460,314	\$59,143	\$94,364	\$50,000	\$256,807

Summary Metrics

Total Projected Units (5yr)	37,554
Total Net Revenue (5yr)	\$460,314
Total Contribution (5yr)	\$256,807
Advance	\$70,000
Breakeven Units	8,568
ROI	155.7%
Payback Year	Year 1

Recommendation

****Recommendation: ACQUIRE****

"The Midnight Garden" by Elena Marchetti presents a compelling opportunity for acquisition in the literary fiction market. The narrative's intricate exploration of family dynamics and the interplay of secrecy strongly aligns with successful titles in this genre, such as "Himself and Black" and "A Specific in New Diane," both of which have demonstrated robust sales, with net revenues exceeding \$200,000. Given the median sales figures of 34,625 units and an average revenue of \$273,790 among comparable titles, the projected figures for Marchetti's work--37,554 units and a net revenue of \$460,314--appear attainable, suggesting a strong market position. The ROI of 155.7% and a payback period of just one year further bolster the case for acquisition.

While the advance of \$70,000 is reasonable given the projected contribution of \$256,807 over five years, it's important to note the performance spread among comparable titles. Most range between \$175,198 and \$8,249,751, indicating that while "The Midnight Garden" may not reach the heights of the highest performers, its thematic depth and narrative complexity suggest it could resonate well with a dedicated readership. The book's emphasis on ambiguity and human concerns is particularly timely, likely appealing to readers seeking nuanced literary experiences, a trend that has been gaining traction in recent years.

****Recommended Advance:**** I recommend an advance of \$70,000 for "The Midnight Garden." This figure aligns with industry standards of 50-70% of projected net revenue for strong titles and reflects confidence in the book's potential to perform effectively in the market while safeguarding our investment.

(Generated by AI editorial analysis)

Methodology: 30 comp titles with genre-specific content (200-500 words). Comp selection via OpenAI semantic embeddings. Forecast based on median comp performance. Revenue model uses blended format pricing, 50% trade discount, 20% return rate. Recommendation via GPT-4o-mini editorial analysis.

Generated on 2026-05-28 | Based on 5 comparable titles selected from 30 candidates